STRIDE ISP 2.3 – GV.RR

Roles, Responsibilities, and Authorities

Version [2.0]

Purpose:

This document defines the Stride standards related to the Roles, Responsibilities, and Authorities component of the NIST Cybersecurity Framework (NIST CSF).

Scope and Applicability

These policies and standards apply to all Stride-owned technology and business operations.

All workforce members and their respective facilities supporting Stride business operations, technology, or both, wherever Stride data is stored or processed, including any third party contracted by Stride to handle, process, transmit, store, or dispose of Stride data are subject to the requirements of this document.

All data, systems, activities, and assets owned, leased, controlled, or used by Stride, its agents, contractors, or other business partners on behalf of Stride are within the scope of the requirements of this document.

The requirements outlined in this document apply where technically feasible and commercially reasonable, as determined by executive management. Any exceptions to these standards must be requested, using the approved workflow and remain documented until compliance has been achieved. Exceptions are only granted temporarily for periods of up to one calendar year.

Definitions

All definitions are located within Stride - ISP 1.2 – IT Policy Definitions.

Any inquiries regarding terminology or clarity may be directed to Stride's Information Security Team for assistance.

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Document Control

This document may contain proprietary, confidential, or sensitive information owned wholly by Stride Inc. Any distribution of the information contained within this document, in whole or in part, outside of Stride or its subsidiary entities requires the approval of the Executive Sponsor.

This document will be reviewed at least annually and re-issued when revisions are necessary. Any changes introduced in the most recent version are itemized below. Obsolete copies should be destroyed or archived upon the release of the newest version.

Implementation and Compliance

All business units are required to comply with any changes applied to the most recent version of this publication within 90 days from the date of publication.

Change History

Version	Date of Change	Summary of Change(s)
1.0	6/15/2022	Initial Release and Publication
1.1	12/01/2022	- Added Change History - Updated and/or redacted language for clarity where necessary
1.2	03/17/2023	- Updated approvals section
1.3	01/01/2024	- Updated Purpose/Scope/Document Control/Implementation and Compliance - Changed formatting to new standard - Changed document images
2.0	01/31/2025	- Major change to align with NIST 2.0 - Added Senior Manager, Information security, Director, IT Disaster Recovery, Identity and Access Governance Manager - Changed Senior Director, Information Security, Audit and Compliance to Governance, Risk and Compliance Manager - Changed Security, Audit, and Compliance Department to Information Security Department - GV.RR-01, GV.RR-02, GV.RR-03, and GV.RR-04 are new additions
2.0	02/24/2025	- Approved Mark Williams - CISO
2.0	02/27/2025	- Published

GV.RR-01 Leadership Accountability

Leadership roles, responsibilities, and accountabilities are necessary for fostering a culture of cybersecurity excellence at Stride. This ensures that all relevant stakeholders, including senior management and the Board of Directors, understand their roles in implementing and overseeing Stride's technology and cybersecurity risk management strategies, third-party risk management, and resilience programs. Furthermore, it highlights Stride's commitment to continuous improvement in managing these risks.

Standards:

- Leadership Accountability for Cybersecurity Risk
    - Stride's leadership is responsible for cybersecurity risk and fosters a culture that is risk-aware, ethical and focused on continual improvement.
- Governing Authority Oversight
    - The governing authority (e.g., the Board of Directors or one of its committees) is accountable for overseeing and holding senior management responsible for implementing Stride's technology and cybersecurity risk management strategies and frameworks. This oversight ensures alignment with Stride's mission and risk appetite.
- Third-Party Risk Management
    - The governing authority (e.g., the Board of Directors or one of its committees) regularly reviews and oversees the execution of Stride's third-party risk management strategy and program. It holds senior management accountable for managing the ongoing risks associated with the use of third-party vendors, ensuring that these risks are appropriately identified, mitigated, and aligned with Stride's overall risk framework.
- Resilience Strategy Oversight
    - The governing authority (e.g., the Board of Directors or one of its committees) regularly reviews and oversees Stride's resilience strategy and program. It holds senior management accountable for managing ongoing resilience risks, ensuring that Stride is prepared to recover from disruptions and maintain its critical functions.
- Cybersecurity Officer Accountability
    - Stride has designated a qualified Vice President of Information Security (also known as the CISO), who is responsible and accountable for developing Stride's cybersecurity strategy, overseeing and implementing the cybersecurity program, and enforcing Stride's cybersecurity policy.

This role ensures that cybersecurity risks are managed effectively and aligned with organizational goals.

- Technology Officer Accountability
    - Stride designates a qualified Technology Officer (e.g., CIO or CTO) who is responsible and accountable for developing Stride's technology strategy, overseeing and implementing its technology program, and enforcing Stride's technology policy. This role ensures that Stride's technology initiatives support business objectives while minimizing risks.
- Security Policy and Program requirements are shared with external or third parties on an as-needed basis to:
    - Allow external parties to understand Stride's commitment to cybersecurity.
    - Display the standard that Stride follows as an organization and expects in reciprocal agreements with vendors, partners, or other parties.
    - Provide as evidence during an audit or investigation.

References:

- SP 800-218: PO.2.3
- CIS Controls v8.0: 14.1
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.RR-01
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.RR-01.01
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.RR-01.02
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.RR-01.03
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.RR-01.04
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.RR-01.05

GV.RR-02 Technology and Cybersecurity Roles & Responsibilities

Roles, responsibilities, and authorities related to cybersecurity are clearly defined, assigned, and communicated to promote accountability, enable performance evaluation, and drive continuous improvement.

Standards:

- Employees are informed of their roles and responsibilities in maintaining a safe and secure working environment.
    - Role-specific training is used to assist in disseminating information security roles and responsibilities within Stride.
    - Training is reviewed, at minimum, once annually.
- All security-related positions are staffed by qualified individuals who have the necessary skills.
- Information and Cybersecurity roles and responsibilities for the entire workforce and third-party stakeholders (e.g., suppliers, customers, partners, contractors, etc.) are:
    - Established and documented.
    - Coordinated and aligned with internal functions and external partners.
- External parties understand the implications of security requirements imposed by Stride and will be tasked to work towards achieving a reciprocal state of awareness and security posturing.
    - The requirements of doing business with or for Stride are communicated within Service Level Agreements (SLA).

References:

- SP 800-218: PO.2.1
- CIS Controls v8.0: 14.9
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.RR-02
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.RR-02.01
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.RR-02.02
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.RR-02.03
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.RR-02.04
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.RR-02.05
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.RR-02.06

- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.RR-02.07
- SP 800-221A: GV.RR-1
- SP 800-221A: GV.RR-2
- SP 800-221A: GV.OV-2
- CSF v1.1: ID.AM-6
- CSF v1.1: ID.GV-2
- CSF v1.1: DE.DP-1

GV.RR-03 Personnel Resources

Stride ensures adequate resources, including personnel, tools, and funding, are allocated to support its cybersecurity risk strategy. This allocation aligns with defined roles, responsibilities, and established policies to effectively mitigate risks, safeguard critical assets, and maintain operational resilience. By providing sufficient resources, Stride fosters a robust cybersecurity program that supports proactive threat management, compliance with regulatory requirements, and continuous improvement in securing its technology and business processes.

Standards:

Stride complies with the Family and Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA), the National Institute of Standards and Technology Cybersecurity Framework (NIST CSF), Sarbanes-Oxley Act of 2002, and various regional laws and regulations.

Training and Briefing

- All personnel, including employees, affiliates, business partners, and contractors who handle data related to these laws and regulations, receive training on the mandated requirements. This ensures everyone is aware of their responsibilities and the necessary compliance measures.

Budgeting and Resourcing

- The organization's budgeting and resourcing processes identify, prioritize, and address resource needs to manage identified technology and cybersecurity risks. This includes addressing skill shortages, headcount, new tools, incident-related expenses, and unsupported systems.

Regular Assessment of Skills and Resources

- Stride regularly assesses its skill and resource level requirements against its current personnel complement to determine gaps. Assessment results are used to improve the cybersecurity program and ensure the organization has the necessary resources to manage its technology and cybersecurity risks effectively.

Support for the Cybersecurity Officer (CISO)

- The organization provides adequate resources, appropriate authority, and access to the governing authority for the designated Cybersecurity Officer (e.g., CISO). This includes providing budgetary support, staff resources, and executive backing to implement and oversee the organization's cybersecurity strategy.

References:

- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.RR-03
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.RR-03.01
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.RR-03.02
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.RR-03.03
- SP 800-221A: GV.RR-2
- CSF v1.1: ID.RM-1

GV.RR-04 Cybersecurity & Human Resources

Stride's Human Resources (HR) department, in partnership with the Information Security department, integrates cybersecurity considerations into all aspects of its operations, from recruitment and onboarding to training and development. We ensure that all personnel handling sensitive information are well-versed in cybersecurity protocols and best practices. Regular training sessions and briefings keep everyone updated on the latest threats and compliance requirements.

Standards

- Stride conducts background checks on all employees and third-party workers during hiring, periodically during their employment, and when their roles change. These checks are aligned with their level of access to critical data and systems.

- When an employee leaves or is terminated, Stride, in partnership with the Information Technology team and the Information Security team, takes steps to reduce cyber risks. This includes ensuring all Stride assets are returned or properly handled in compliance with legal requirements.

- All personnel, including employees, affiliates, business partners, and contractors who handle data related to these laws and regulations, receive training on mandated requirements. This ensures everyone is aware of their responsibilities and the necessary compliance measures.

- The organization's budgeting and resourcing processes identify, prioritize, and address resource needs to manage identified technology and cybersecurity risks. This includes addressing skill shortages, headcount, new tools, incident-related expenses, and unsupported systems.

- Stride regularly assesses its skill and resource level requirements against its current personnel complement to determine gaps. This helps in ensuring that the organization has the necessary resources to manage its technology and cybersecurity risks effectively.

- The organization provides adequate resources, appropriate authority, and access to the governing authority for the designated Cybersecurity Officer (e.g., CISO). This support is crucial for the CISO to implement and oversee the organization's cybersecurity strategy.

References:

- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.RR-03
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.RR-03.01
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.RR-03.02
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.RR-03.03
- SP 800-221A: GV.RR-2
- CSF v1.1: ID.RM-1

KEY ROLE DESCRIPTIONS

Chief Executive Office, President (CEO)

- Hold overall responsibility for privacy and security in accordance with regulations, laws, and requirements

Chief Information Security Officer (CISO)

- Ensures the security of data and information collected, created and maintained by Stride.

Chief Technology Officer (CTO)

- Oversees corporate information technology and integrates business needs and requirements into IT planning and operations.

Chief Information Officer (CIO)

- Manages the people, processes, and technologies within Stride's IT organization to deliver outcomes that support the business goals.

Vice President, Cloud, and Infrastructure Operations

- Plans, deploys and maintains cloud systems and processes for Stride.

Senior Manager, Information Security

- Implements and manages Stride's information security program, including application security, security engineering, vulnerability management, and incident response to ensure compliance with security policies and standards.

Director, IT Disaster Recovery

- Develops and executes Stride's disaster recovery and business continuity plans.

Identity and Access Governance Manager

- Manages identity and access controls, ensuring that only authorized individuals have access to Stride resources.

Governance, Risk and Compliance Manager

- Oversees security, audit and compliance with state, federal, and international regulations, laws, and requirements in the geographic area where Stride operates.

DEPARTMENT RESPONSIBILITIES

Information Security Department

- Is responsible for implementing and managing Stride's information security program, overseeing the security operations including application security, security engineering, vulnerability management, and incident response to ensure compliance with security policies and standards.

- Responsible for planning, deploying, and maintaining Stride's disaster recovery and business continuity plans.

- Manages identity and access controls to ensure only authorized individuals have access to Stride resources.

- Ensures security, audit, and compliance with state, federal, and international regulations, laws, and requirements in the geographic area Stride operates.

Internal Audit Department

- Under the direction of the Vice President, Internal Auditor, the Internal Audit Department is responsible for monitoring compliance with the policy requirements, controls, and procedures outlined by the security policies.

- Defining and coordinating the enterprise risk assessment process including the identification of information security risks to be leveraged by the Security Review Committee (SRC) and Security teams.

Legal Department

- Under the direction of the Chief Legal Counsel, the Legal Department is responsible for identifying regulations, filings, and legal requirements that impact Stride's information and assets, notifying Internal Audit and the SRC team of new or modifications to regulations, and filings.

Privacy Department

- Under the direction of the Data Privacy Officer, the Privacy Department is responsible for the privacy of data and information collected, created, and maintained by Stride.

Information Technology Department

- Under the direction of the CIO, the IT Department is responsible for planning, deploying, and maintaining IT systems and operations for Stride.

Cloud Operations

- Under the direction of the Vice President, Cloud, and Infrastructure Operations, Cloud Operations is responsible for planning, deploying, and maintaining cloud systems and operations for Stride.